SCHOOL OF COMMUNICATION, CINEMATICS & CREATIVE ARTS

SEMESTER: Fall, 2026
COURSE: Media Management, JRN 3015A
LECTURER: Dr. Ruth Owino
ASSIGNMENT2: Developing and Launching a Media Product or Service
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Assignment Title: From Concept to Market: Designing a Viable Media Product or Service

Assignment Type: Group Project (4–5 students)

Total Marks: 60 Marks

Assignment Overview

The media industry is undergoing significant transformation driven by digital technologies, changing audience consumption patterns, evolving revenue models, artificial intelligence, and increased competition for audience attention. Traditional media organisations and emerging digital media enterprises must continuously innovate to remain competitive, financially sustainable, and relevant to their audiences. In this assignment, you will assume the role of a media entrepreneur or management team tasked with developing an innovative, commercially viable and sustainable media product or service for the Kenyan or wider African market. Your challenge is to move beyond simply proposing a creative idea. You must demonstrate how the product or service will be developed, managed, financed, marketed, distributed, and sustained in a competitive media environment. The assignment will test your ability to apply media management principles to a realistic entrepreneurial challenge.

Assignment Scenario

Imagine that your team has been selected to participate in the USIU-Africa Media Innovation and Entrepreneurship Challenge 2026. A group of potential investors is offering seed funding to promising student-led media ventures that demonstrate creativity, commercial potential, audience relevance, and long-term sustainability. Your team must develop an original media product or service that addresses an identifiable market gap, audience need or emerging opportunity.

You will pitch your concept to a panel of potential investors who will evaluate its feasibility, market potential, management structure, revenue model, and competitive advantage.

Convince the investors that your media venture is not merely an interesting idea but a viable business worth supporting. Students may develop an original concept in any of the following categories or propose another relevant media innovation.

i. Digital media and content production: A specialised podcast network, digital news platform, investigative journalism service, documentary production company or youth-focused online magazine.
ii. Media technology and platforms: A local-language news application, AI-assisted media monitoring service, fact-checking platform, creator monetisation platform or audience analytics service.
iii. Creative media and entertainment: A short-form video production company, animation studio, digital storytelling platform, online entertainment channel or branded-content agency.
iv. Community and specialised media services: A community information service, agricultural media platform, campus media enterprise, educational media product or media literacy training service.

Your team must prepare a comprehensive media venture proposal addressing the following components.

Task 1: Media Product or Service Concept (8 marks)

a. Develop and explain your proposed media venture. Address the following:
b. Name of the media product or service and its brand identity.
c. Description of the product or service, including its main features.
d. The specific audience problem, information gap, or market opportunity it addresses.
e. The product's unique value proposition.
f. How the proposed product differs from existing media offerings.

Expected output: A clear product concept supported by a name, tagline, and basic visual identity or branding mock-up.

Task 2: Market Research and Audience Analysis (10 marks)

Conduct preliminary market research to establish the demand and potential audience for your proposed product or service. Your analysis should include:

a. Identification and profiling of your primary and secondary target audiences.
b. Audience characteristics, interests, media consumption habits, and unmet needs.Analysis of at least three existing competitors in the Kenyan or African media market.
c. Identification of your competitive advantage.
d. Evidence of audience demand using credible secondary research and/or primary research such as interviews, surveys or focus groups.

Expected output: Audience personas, competitor analysis and evidence supporting the market opportunity.

Task 3: Media Operations and Management Structure (8 marks)

a. Demonstrate how the media venture will operate as an organisation. Explain:
b. The proposed organisational structure and key management roles.
c. Staffing requirements and responsibilities.
d. Production processes and workflow, from content development to distribution.
e. Technology, equipment and infrastructure requirements.
f. Editorial or content quality assurance mechanisms.
g. Ethical, legal and regulatory considerations relevant to the product.

Expected output: A simple organisational chart and operational workflow showing how the product or service will be produced and managed.

Task 4: Business Model and Financial Sustainability (12 marks)

Develop a realistic financial and revenue strategy. Address:

a. The proposed business model: advertising, subscriptions, sponsorships, licensing, commissions, partnerships, service fees or a hybrid approach.Initial start-up costs, including equipment, software, staffing and marketing.
b. Estimated monthly operating expenses.
c. Pricing strategy and justification.
d. Projected monthly revenue for the first six months.
e. Break-even analysis and financial risks. (All financial estimates must be presented in Kenyan shillings (KES) and supported by reasonable assumptions).

Expected output: A start-up budget, six-month financial projection and explanation of the venture's financial viability.

Task 5: Marketing, Distribution and Audience Growth (8 marks)

Develop a marketing and distribution strategy that demonstrates how the media product or service will attract, retain and grow its audience. Include:

a. Branding and market positioning.
b. Content distribution channels and platforms.
c. Digital marketing, social media and promotional strategies.
d. Audience engagement and community-building approaches.
e. Potential strategic partnerships.
f. At least three measurable key performance indicators, such as audience reach, engagement, subscriber growth, customer acquisition or retention.

Expected output: A practical three-month marketing and audience development plan.

Task 6: Product Prototype and Investor Pitch (14 marks)

Your team must create a basic prototype or sample demonstrating how the proposed product or service would work.Depending on the nature of your venture, the prototype may include:

a. A 2–3-minute podcast or video pilot.
b. A sample digital magazine or newsletter.
c. A wireframe or interactive mock-up of a media application.
d. A sample website or news platform.
e. A media service portfolio with sample client deliverables.
f. A demonstration of a proposed media technology solution.
g. The prototype must demonstrate the product's core features and user experience.

Investor pitch: Prepare a 10-15 minute presentation explaining the problem, solution, target audience, market opportunity, business model, financial projections, and why the venture deserves investment.

6. Submission Requirements

i. Each group must submit a professional media business proposal of approximately 8–12 pages, excluding the cover page, references, and appendices.
ii. The proposal must be typed in Times New Roman, font size 12, with 1.5 line spacing. All sources must be cited using APA 7th edition referencing.

iii. The submission should include the written proposal, a financial budget, a product prototype or demonstration link, and the investor pitch slides. Each group should also attach a brief statement.

iv. The proposed product or service must be original or demonstrate a significant improvement on an existing media offering. Students are expected to make realistic management and financial decisions rather than simply describe an ideal media business.

v. The use of AI tools is permitted for brainstorming, research assistance, and prototype development, provided their use is disclosed. However, only 30% AI and the rest should be human element. Students must independently verify information, financial assumptions, and market evidence.

vi. A visually appealing prototype alone will not earn high marks if the business model is weak. Equally, a strong business proposal must be supported by a credible product demonstration.

vii. There will be a Media Investors' Boardroom on Week 11. Each goup will be expected to conduct the final presentations as a simulated media investment competition.

viii. Each group presents its media venture to an investor panel, while the remaining students act as potential investors and competitors. After each pitch, the panel has five minutes to challenge the group on its revenue assumptions, audience strategy, management decisions and market feasibility.

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